

Email routing — Fly GACA

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OWNER Founder

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How the public-facing `@flygaca.com` addresses map to real inboxes.

Where this is actually configured: forwarding/aliasing lives at the mail provider for the `flygaca.com` domain (Google Workspace routing or Cloudflare Email Routing) — **not** in this repository. This file is the source of truth for *what the scheme should be*; apply it in the provider's console and keep the two in sync. The repo only controls which address each page *displays*.

Destinations

Every role address below forwards to **both** of these inboxes:

- `i@flygaca.com` — the canonical, on-brand inbox (primary).
- [personal backup inbox – recorded in the password manager, not in this repo].

`i@flygaca.com` is itself the brand inbox; it forwards onward to the personal backup inbox (recorded in the password manager, not in this repo) so nothing is missed.

Role addresses

Address	Purpose	Surfaced on
<code>i@flygaca.com</code>	General contact, questions, corrections/feedback	Footer (every page), About, Terms, Disclaimer, document "report a problem"
<code>support@flygaca.com</code>	Product, account & billing support	About, Settings (plan/cancellation)
<code>sales@flygaca.com</code>	Flight-school seats & business / B2B enquiries	About
<code>info@flygaca.com</code>	General information (alias of <code>i@</code>)	— (alias only)
<code>hr@flygaca.com</code>	Careers / hiring	About
<code>captadel@flygaca.com</code>	Captain Adel feedback & issues	About
<code>privacy@flygaca.com</code>	PDPL / data-protection (legal controller contact)	Privacy notice, About

Legacy

Address	Status
<code>hello@flygaca.com</code>	Retired as the displayed contact (replaced by <code>i@flygaca.com</code>). Keep it alive as a forwarding alias so older links and printed material still reach us.
<code>[founder-controlled mailbox – recorded in the password manager]</code>	Founder/account address (used for Firebase project ownership — see <code>06-operations-it/runbooks/runbook-deploy.md</code>). Not a public contact.

Notes

- The **staff/admin allow-list identity** used in code (`assets/js/store.js`, `functions/staff.js`) is a founder-controlled mailbox recorded in the secrets inventory (password manager) — intentionally NOT named in this repo. That is an auth mechanism, unrelated to contact routing — do not change it when updating contact addresses.
- The official `@gaca.gov.sa` addresses that appear in `assets/data/` are real GACA regulatory contacts from the source corpus — never rewrite them.

Provider setup — Cloudflare Email Routing (chosen)

Free, receive-and-forward only (no mailbox). `flygaca.com`'s DNS and the website are both **already on Cloudflare** (Cloudflare DNS + Cloudflare Pages), so there is no nameserver migration and no Firebase records to protect — Email Routing is independent of the Pages site and just adds MX/TXT records.

- Enable Email Routing.** In Cloudflare for `flygaca.com`: **Email → Email Routing → Get started / Enable**. Cloudflare auto-creates the `MX` records and the `SPF` (`TXT`) record. (If any stale `MX` /mail `TXT` records remain from a previous host, delete them so only Cloudflare's exist.)
- Destination addresses** → add and verify (click the confirmation email):
 - the personal backup inbox (recorded in the password manager, not in this repo)
 - the real inbox behind `i@flygaca.com` (a Gmail/Hotmail you actually read)
- Routing rules** — one per role address, each → `i@flygaca.com`: `support@`, `sales@`, `info@`, `hr@`, `captadel@`, `privacy@`, and the legacy `hello@`. Add a **catch-all** → `i@flygaca.com` so any future address still lands.
- Fan-out to both inboxes:** a Cloudflare rule has one destination, so point everything at `i@flygaca.com` and have that inbox auto-forward a copy to the personal backup inbox (or use an Email Worker for a true two-destination split).

The MX/TXT records are not proxied (no orange/grey-cloud choice for mail), and they don't touch the Pages site's own records, so the website is unaffected. After a few minutes: send a test to each address and confirm it lands; verify MX/SPF with <https://toolbox.googleapps.com/apps/checkmx/>.

Limitation (receive-only): replies leave from whichever inbox you read them in, **not** from `i@flygaca.com`. If you later need to *send as* `i@flygaca.com`, move to Google Workspace (one seat + aliases) — the role addresses above become send-as aliases of the `i@` user.

Troubleshooting & upgrades

Getting send-as `i@flygaca.com` (beyond receive-only)

Cloudflare Email Routing has no outbound SMTP, so it can only receive/forward — replies go out from your personal inbox. Receive-only is fine to launch with; upgrade when you want the brand

`From:`. Options, simplest first:

Route	Cost	Notes
Zoho Mail free tier	Free	Real mailbox for one domain with send-as. Swap Cloudflare's MX for Zoho's MX.
Google Workspace (1 seat)	~\$6/mo	Real <code>i@</code> mailbox; the role addresses become send-as aliases of that user. Cleanest given the existing Google footprint.
Cloudflare forwarding + outbound SMTP relay (Brevo/Mailgun) wired into Gmail "Send mail as"	Free—cheap	Most fiddly; only worth it to avoid running a real mailbox.

If send-as matters from day one, pick **Zoho free** or **Workspace** and use *their* MX records instead of Cloudflare Email Routing — at that point the forwarding-only setup above is replaced, not added to.